



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

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— Tantravārttika, Chapter 1 Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

The Tantravārttika, in these verses, speaks to the nature of understanding scripture, particularly when faced with ambiguity or lack of obvious meaning. It tells us that if something we search for in scripture lacks clear, widespread recognition, we are permitted to imagine its meaning through the avenues that are shown to us. This doesn't mean we can invent anything; rather, we use the framework the text itself provides. When faced with ideas that seem scattered, multi-faceted, and create doubt, we should only tentatively accept them when there is absolutely no other way to interpret the text.

The scripture reminds you that etymology, or the meaning of words, is not useless just because the apparent meaning is obscured. True understanding comes from a deep knowledge of the six limbs of the Vedas (phonetics, ritual, grammar, etymology, metrics, and astronomy) and from understanding how actions performed according to Vedic injunctions bring about their intended results. This is not just about intellectual understanding; it's about a holistic comprehension that integrates knowledge, action, and result.

In modern life, this wisdom is incredibly relevant. We are constantly bombarded with information, much of it ambiguous or contradictory. Think of the constant debates and differing opinions you encounter online, or the varying interpretations of political events. Just like in interpreting scripture, we must be discerning, seeking underlying principles and avoiding superficial conclusions. We should approach information with a solid foundation of knowledge, gained through diligent study and critical thinking. When facing conflicting interpretations, we should seek the most holistic understanding, one that integrates diverse perspectives and accounts for potential consequences. Just as the Tantravārttika suggests, we must avoid leaping to conclusions based on incomplete information, and instead, cultivate a deep understanding of the underlying principles at play. This will lead to more balanced and informed judgments.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

Are you diligently seeking a comprehensive understanding before forming opinions, or are you often swayed by superficial appearances and incomplete information?